Language Usage practice booklet: Grade 5 expectations

Grade 5 · Practice booklet

Name: _____

What this booklet is

This is general practice written for Language Usage at Grade 5 level, following the Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts standards for that grade. It is not made from your child's MAP questions, and it does not replace the classroom. Use it as a guide to what a child is expected to know and do at this level.

How to use it

- Do one section at a time, about 10 minutes, 3 days a week. Stop while it is still enjoyable.
- Read each question all the way through, twice, before answering. Underline the key words and say what is being asked.
- Take your time. A careful, correct answer is worth more than a fast one.
- Use scrap paper and show the working. Then check the answer before moving on.
- Ask your child to explain how they got an answer, even when it is right.
- If a section feels too hard, do the section before it again, or ask the teacher. That is part of learning, not a problem.

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

Standards practised: L.5.2, L.5.2a, L.5.2b, L.5.2c, L.5.2d, L.5.2e

A worked example

Correct this sentence: after school on tuesday maryam bought dates milk and bread at the souq

1. Capital letters: the day Tuesday and the name Maryam.
2. A comma after the opening phrase: After school on Tuesday, Maryam ...
3. Commas between the items in a list: dates, milk, and bread.
4. A full stop at the end.

After school on Tuesday, Maryam bought dates, milk, and bread at the souq.

Questions

1. Which sentence uses capital letters correctly?

   A. On friday, Salem visited Dubai Mall with his cousin.

   B. On Friday, Salem visited Dubai Mall with his cousin.

   C. On Friday, salem visited dubai mall with his cousin.

   D. on Friday, Salem visited Dubai Mall with his cousin.

2. Choose the word that completes the sentence: The children put ____ bags by the door.

   A. their

   B. there

   C. they're

   D. thier

3. Add the commas: Maryam packed dates water a hat and sunscreen for the desert trip.

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4. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?
   A. After the sun set the camels, walked quietly home.
   B. After the sun set the camels walked, quietly home.
   C. After the sun set, the camels walked quietly home.
   D. After, the sun set the camels walked quietly home.

5. Punctuate it: Noura you are ready for the race aren't you

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6. Choose the correct way to show the title of the poem Rain on the Creek: quotation marks or italics?

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7. Which word is spelled correctly?
   A. recieve
   B. receeve
   C. receve
   D. receive

8. Choose the right word: The dhow sailed (threw / through) the narrow part of the creek.

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9. Which sentence shows that the pencil belongs to Maryam?
   A. Khalid borrowed Maryams pencil.
   B. Khalid borrowed Maryams' pencil.
   C. Khalid borrowed Maryam's pencil.
   D. Khalid borrowed Maryams's pencil.

10. Punctuate it: Salem asked Where is the metro station

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11. Add a comma: The souq was busy but Omar found the spice shop quickly.

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12. Explain why one of these sentences is wrong: (a) I visited Abu Dhabi in March. (b) I visited the city in march.

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

Standards practised: L.5.1, L.5.1a, L.5.1b, L.5.1c, L.5.1d, L.5.1e, L.5.3, L.5.3a, L.5.4, L.5.4a, L.5.4b, L.5.4c, L.5.5, L.5.5a, L.5.5b, L.5.5c, L.5.6

A worked example

Choose the correct verb and say why: By the time Hind reached the stadium, the match (started / had started).

1. Two things happened in the past. The match began first, then Hind arrived.
2. The earlier action uses the past perfect: had + the past participle.
3. So the match had started.

had started

Questions

1. Choose the right verb: Hamdan ____ the space exhibition three times.
   A. has visiting
   B. has visited
   C. have visited
   D. has visit

2. Choose the right verb: By the time we got to the creek, the dhow ____.
   A. leaves
   B. will leave
   C. had left
   D. has left

3. Choose the right verb: By sunset tomorrow, the fishermen ____ their work.
   A. will have finished
   B. had finished
   C. have finish
   D. finished

4. Which sentence keeps the tense the same?
   A. Layla walked to the souq and bought some dates.
   B. Layla walked to the souq and buys some dates.
   C. Layla walks to the souq and bought some dates.
   D. Layla walked to the souq and buying some dates.

5. Complete the pair of words: Either Hind ____ Khalid will carry the water bottles.

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6. Choose the right pair: (Neither / Either) Salem nor Noura has seen a real oryx.

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7. Name the preposition and say what it shows: The dhow sailed across the creek.

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8. Which word is the conjunction in this sentence? Maryam wanted to swim, but the pool was closed.
   A. wanted
   B. pool
   C. closed
   D. but

9. Which word is the interjection? Wow, the Burj Khalifa is so tall!
   A. tall
   B. Khalifa
   C. so
   D. Wow

10. Combine into one smooth sentence: The falcon is fast. The falcon is brown. The falcon flew over the dunes.

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11. Explain the difference in meaning: (a) Salem has lived in Sharjah for six years. (b) Salem lived in Sharjah for six years.

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12. Use the context to choose the meaning of nocturnal. The fennec fox is nocturnal, so it sleeps in its burrow by day and hunts at night.

    A. active at night

    B. very quiet

    C. very large

    D. active in the morning

13. The Greek root bio means life, logy means the study of, and graph means write. What do the words biology and biography mean?

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14. The Latin root port means carry. Using it, and the prefix or suffix, explain the meaning of (a) transport (trans = across), (b) portable (able = can be), (c) export (ex = out).

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15. Which reference book would you use to check how to say a new word and what part of speech it is?

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16. Name the kind of figurative language (simile, metaphor or idiom) and explain what it means. (a) The dunes were a sea of gold at sunset. (b) The falcon swooped like an arrow. (c) Salem was over the moon when the Hope Probe launched.

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17. Explain what this adage means: Actions speak louder than words.

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18. Which word is an antonym (opposite) of generous?

    A. kind

    B. giving

    C. selfish

    D. huge

19. The word wind is spelled the same in two sentences: 'Please wind the string around the stick' and 'A strong wind blew across the dunes.' Does it mean the same in both? Explain, and name this kind of word.

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20. Choose the best word from the box to complete each sentence. One word is not needed. Box: however, in addition, therefore, although. (a) The market has fresh dates; ____, it sells spices. (b) ____ the desert is hot, many animals live there. (c) Layla studied the map carefully; ____, she found the route easily.

Section 3: Writing

Standards practised: W.5.1, W.5.1a, W.5.1b, W.5.1c, W.5.2, W.5.2a, W.5.2b, W.5.2c, W.5.3, W.5.4, W.5.5, W.5.7, W.5.8, W.5.9, W.5.10, SL.5.1, SL.5.2, SL.5.3, SL.5.4, SL.5.5, SL.5.6

A worked example

Plan an opinion paragraph: should your class have a reading corner? Write an opinion and two reasons.

1. State the opinion clearly: Our class should have a reading corner.
2. Reason 1: it gives a quiet place to read when work is finished.
3. Reason 2: children who read more find new words and ideas.
4. Plan a closing sentence that repeats the opinion.

Opinion: Our class should have a reading corner. Reasons: a quiet place to read, and more reading builds new words and ideas. Closing: A reading corner would help everyone enjoy books.

Questions

1. Put these sentences in order to make a paragraph: (1) That is why mangroves are worth protecting. (2) Mangroves are trees that grow in salty water along the coast of the UAE. (3) Fish and crabs also hide among the roots. (4) Their roots hold the mud in place and protect the shore.

   A. 1, 2, 3, 4

   B. 2, 4, 3, 1

   C. 2, 3, 4, 1

   D. 4, 2, 3, 1

2. Plan it: you will persuade your school to start a recycling bin for plastic bottles. Write your opinion and two reasons.

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3. Which is the better opinion sentence?

   A. Recycling is a thing.

   B. Recycling bins are fine.

   C. I like bins.

   D. Our school should add recycling bins because they keep plastic out of the sea.

4. Which is the best topic sentence for a paragraph about how a desalination plant makes drinking water?

   A. A desalination plant turns salty sea water into water that is safe to drink.

   B. I went to a desalination plant last year.

   C. Water is blue.

   D. Many people like drinking water.

5. Which linking word or phrase best completes the passage? Parks help children stay healthy. ____, they give families a place to meet.

   A. However

   B. In addition

   C. Therefore

   D. Instead

6. Which sentence does not belong in a paragraph about animals of the Hajar mountains?

   A. Arabian tahr climb steep rocky slopes.

   B. Some birds nest in the cliffs.

   C. My cousin has a red bicycle.

   D. Lizards rest on warm rocks.

7. Plan a short story. Fill in a planner with a character, a setting, a problem, three main events and an ending. Use this start: Hind and her cousins find a lost key on the beach.

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8. Revise to add detail: We went to a place and saw an animal.

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9. Which is the best concluding sentence for this paragraph? The Dubai Metro helps people travel without cars. It runs above the ground and under it, and trains arrive often. Fewer cars on the road means cleaner air.

   A. The metro has many stations.

   B. For these reasons, the metro is a smart way to travel around the city.

   C. Cars cost a lot of money to buy.

   D. I rode a bus yesterday.

10. Which sentence best revises this one to avoid repeated words? Khalid likes the souq. Khalid likes the souq because the souq smells of spices.

    A. Khalid likes the souq, Khalid likes the souq because the souq smells of spices.

    B. Khalid likes the souq because the souq likes spices.

    C. Khalid likes the souq, because souq smells of spices.

    D. Khalid likes the souq because it smells of spices.

11. List three things to check when you proofread your writing.

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12. Explain two reasons why it helps to plan before you write a first draft.

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13. Listening, part one (parent task). Read this talk aloud once, calmly and clearly: "Mangrove trees should be planted along more of our coast. First, their roots calm the waves and protect the shore. Second, young fish hide among the roots, so fishermen catch more later. Finally, the trees take in carbon dioxide from the air." Then say: "Tell me in your own words what the speaker wants and the reasons given."

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14. Listening, part two (parent task). Read the talk aloud again. Then say: "Pick one reason the speaker gives. Tell me how it supports the idea that we should plant more mangroves."

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15. Presentation (parent task). Your child chooses a topic such as the Dubai Metro and prepares three facts and two describing details. They may hold a card with one sentence or a simple drawing. Say: "Please tell me about your topic in about one minute. Speak clearly at a steady pace, in complete sentences, in formal English, as if you were speaking to your class."

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16. Discussion (parent task). First, your child reads a short book or article about a topic (one chosen by an adult). Then say: "Let us talk about it. Our rule is that we take turns and do not interrupt. Ask me two questions that need more than yes or no. I will answer, and you build on my answer. At the end, sum up the main ideas in two sentences."

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17. Research plan (parent task). Pick a topic such as how the Hope Probe studies Mars. (a) Write one research question. (b) Name two different kinds of sources you could use (a website is optional and only with an adult), and say how you would list one of them.

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18. Paraphrase (parent task). Read this sentence to your child: "The probe orbits the planet and measures how its air changes through the day." Say: "Put this in your own words, without copying."

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19. Using evidence. Read: "The Arabian oryx almost disappeared from the wild because too many were caught. A breeding programme then raised oryx safely, and later they were returned to protected desert reserves." Write two or three sentences to answer: How did people help the oryx? Use evidence from the paragraph.

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20. Write one sentence about the oryx for a friend and one for the school newsletter.

Answer guide for parents

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

1. B. On Friday, Salem visited Dubai Mall with his cousin. Days, names and places start with capital letters, and so does the first word of the sentence. If your child chose A, they forgot the capital on Friday. If they chose C, they left Salem and Dubai Mall in small letters.
2. A. their. 'Their' shows the bags belong to the children. 'There' is a place and 'they're' means they are. If your child chose B, they used the word for a place. If they chose C, they used 'they are', which does not fit here.
3. Maryam packed dates, water, a hat, and sunscreen for the desert trip. Commas separate the items in a list (the comma before 'and' is optional). Ask: can you count the items and check there is a comma between each?
4. C. After the sun set, the camels walked quietly home. A comma follows an opening clause, so it goes after 'set': 'After the sun set, the camels walked quietly home.' If your child chose A, they put the comma after 'camels', which splits the sentence in the wrong place.
5. Noura, you are ready for the race, aren't you? Commas set off a name being spoken to and a tag question, and the sentence ends with a question mark. Ask: who is being spoken to, and is the sentence asking something?
6. Quotation marks: "Rain on the Creek". Short works such as poems and short stories use quotation marks, while book titles are underlined or in italics. Ask: is a poem a short piece or a whole book?
7. D. receive. Remember 'i before e, except after c', so it is receive. If your child chose A, they wrote 'ie' after the c. If they chose C, they left out the i, so ask them to say the word slowly and count the sounds.
8. Through. 'Threw' is the past tense of throw, but here the dhow moved from one side of the creek to the other. Ask: can you replace the word with 'by way of'? If so, it is 'through'.
9. C. Khalid borrowed Maryam's pencil. An apostrophe plus s after one person's name shows the pencil belongs to her: Maryam's. If your child chose A, they left out the apostrophe. If they chose B, they put it after the s, which would mean more than one Maryam.
10. Salem asked, "Where is the metro station?" A comma comes before the quotation, the speech starts with a capital, and the question mark sits inside the quotation marks. Ask: which words did Salem say aloud?
11. The souq was busy, but Omar found the spice shop quickly. A comma goes before 'but' when it joins two complete sentences. Ask: can each part stand alone as a sentence?
12. Sentence (b) is wrong because months are names and begin with a capital letter: March. In sentence (a) both Abu Dhabi and March are correct. Ask: which words in each sentence are names, and do they all start with a capital?

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

1. B. has visited. Use has plus the past participle for one person: has visited. If your child chose C, they used 'have', which is for more than one person. If they chose A, they used 'visiting', which is not the right form after 'has'.
2. C. had left. The leaving happened before we arrived, and 'by the time' needs the past perfect: had left. If your child chose D, they used 'has left', which is for the present. If they

chose A, 'leaves' ignores that it already happened.

3. A. will have finished. The work will be complete before a time in the future, so we need the future perfect: will have finished. If your child chose B, they used 'had finished', which is about the past. If they chose D, 'finished' ignores the future time.
4. A. Layla walked to the souq and bought some dates. Both actions happened in the past, so both verbs stay in the past: walked and bought. If your child chose B, they changed to 'buys', which is the present. If they chose C, they started in the present and switched to the past.
5. or. 'Either' always goes with 'or', as in 'Either Hind or Khalid'. Ask: which word pairs with 'neither', and which pairs with 'either'?
6. Neither. 'Neither' goes with 'nor', and the sentence says that no one has seen a real oryx. Ask: is the sentence saying that both people have not seen one, or that one of them has?
7. The preposition is 'across', and it shows where the dhow sailed, the path of its movement. Ask: which word tells us where, or in what direction, the dhow went?
8. D. but. The word 'but' is the conjunction, because it joins two ideas and shows a contrast. If your child chose A, B or C, they picked a word from inside one idea. Ask: which word joins the two halves of the sentence?
9. D. Wow. 'Wow' is the interjection, a word that shows a sudden feeling. If your child chose A, they picked 'tall', which describes the tower. Ask: which word shows the speaker's surprise?
10. Model answer: The fast, brown falcon flew over the dunes. Any single sentence with all three ideas is fine, as long as it reads smoothly. Ask: can you read it aloud and hear whether it flows?
11. (a) Salem still lives in Sharjah now (present perfect). (b) The six years are finished and he no longer lives there (simple past). Ask: in which sentence does Salem still live in Sharjah?
12. A. active at night. The clue is 'sleeps in its burrow by day and hunts at night', so nocturnal means active at night. If your child chose D, they picked the opposite. If they chose B, they guessed from the word 'sleeps' without reading on.
13. Biology is the study of living things (bio means life, logy means the study of). A biography is a written account of a person's life (bio and graph, to write). Ask: which part of each word tells you what it is about?
14. (a) Transport means to carry across from one place to another. (b) Portable means able to be carried. (c) Export means to carry goods out of a country. Ask: which part of each word means carry, and which part changes the meaning?
15. A dictionary. It shows how to say a word and what part of speech it is. Ask: which book would you use to find another word that means the same?
16. (a) A metaphor: it says the dunes ARE a sea of gold, with no 'like' or 'as'. (b) A simile: it uses 'like' to compare, so the falcon dived fast and straight. (c) An idiom: Salem was extremely happy, not above the moon. Ask: which sentence uses 'like' or 'as'?
17. What people do shows what they really mean more than what they say. Example: helping a friend shows kindness more than only saying you are kind. Ask: can you think of a time someone showed you something by what they did?
18. C. selfish. A generous person gives freely, and the opposite is selfish. If your child chose A or B, they picked a word that means the same, not the reverse. Ask: does the word mean the same as generous, or the opposite?

19. No. In 'wind the string' (rhymes with kind) it means to turn or twist. In 'a strong wind' (rhymes with pinned) it means moving air. Words spelled the same with different meanings are homographs. Ask: how does the word sound in each sentence?
20. (a) in addition adds another fact. (b) Although shows contrast. (c) therefore shows a result. However is not needed. Ask: does each sentence add something, show a contrast, or show a result?

Section 3: Writing

1. B. 2, 4, 3, 1. The topic sentence comes first (2), then the roots (4), then 'also' adds another detail (3), and the closing sentence is last (1). If your child chose A, they put the conclusion first. If they chose C, they put 'also' before the roots it adds to.
2. A good answer states a clear opinion and gives two different reasons, each with a fact or example. Model: Our school should start a recycling bin for plastic bottles because it keeps litter out of the desert and teaches us to look after our country. Ask: what is your strongest reason?
3. D. Our school should add recycling bins because they keep plastic out of the sea. The best opinion says what should happen and gives a reason. If your child chose A, B or C, they picked a vague sentence. Ask: which sentence tells you what to do and why?
4. A. A desalination plant turns salty sea water into water that is safe to drink. A topic sentence names the topic and tells the reader what the paragraph will explain. If your child chose B, they picked a sentence about a visit, which does not explain how the plant works.
5. B. In addition. 'In addition' adds a second idea. 'However' and 'Instead' show contrast, and 'Therefore' shows a result. If your child chose C, they used 'Therefore', but parks being a meeting place is not a result of keeping children healthy.
6. C. My cousin has a red bicycle. A paragraph should keep to one topic. The bicycle is not about animals of the mountains. If your child chose A, B or D, ask them to check that sentence: each one is about an animal.
7. A good plan has named characters (Hind and her cousins), a setting (the beach), a problem (whose key is it?), three events in order, and an ending that solves the problem. Answers will vary. Ask: what happens first, next and last?
8. Model: On Friday we went to the beach and saw a crab scuttling across the wet sand. A better answer names the time, the place and the animal, and says what it did. Ask: can you add where, when and what the animal did?
9. B. For these reasons, the metro is a smart way to travel around the city. A conclusion restates the main idea and does not add a new fact. If your child chose A, C or D, they picked a sentence that adds a new fact. Ask: which sentence brings the whole paragraph together?
10. D. Khalid likes the souq because it smells of spices. The word 'it' and one joined sentence remove the repetition. If your child chose A, they only joined the sentences and kept the repeated words. If they chose B, 'the souq likes spices' changes the meaning.
11. Any three of: capital letters, end punctuation, commas, apostrophes, spelling, the verb tense stays the same, every sentence is complete. Ask: can you read it aloud and listen for mistakes?
12. A good answer gives two reasons, such as: the ideas can be put in a clear order; you can check that every detail fits the topic; it is easier to see what is missing before you start; and

you repeat yourself less. Ask: what would happen if you started with no plan?

13. A good retelling gives the claim (plant more mangroves) and the three reasons in order: the roots protect the shore, young fish hide there so fishermen catch more later, and the trees take in carbon dioxide. It uses the child's own words. Ask: what was the speaker's first reason?
14. A good answer links one reason to the claim. Example: the roots protect the shore, so planting more mangroves keeps the coast safe. Or: fish hide in the roots, so more mangroves means more fish for fishermen. Ask: how does that reason help the speaker's idea?
15. Listen for: a clear opening, three relevant facts in a sensible order, descriptive details, a calm clear voice that is not rushed, complete sentences, and formal English (not slang). The card or drawing should help the listener understand a point. Ask: which fact would you like to hear more about?
16. Listen for: the child read the text beforehand, asks questions that need more than yes or no, takes turns, builds on what you said, and ends with a short summary of the main ideas. Ask: can you sum up the main ideas in two sentences?
17. (a) An open question, for example: What does the Hope Probe measure on Mars? (b) Two kinds, for example a library book and an interview with a teacher (or a trusted website with an adult). A listed source gives the title, the author or website name, and the date. Ask: how would a friend find your source?
18. A paraphrase keeps the meaning and changes the words, for example: The spacecraft circles Mars and checks how the air shifts from morning to night. It must not copy the sentence. Ask: which words did you change, and is the meaning the same?
19. A good answer says people ran a breeding programme to raise oryx safely and then returned them to protected reserves, and refers to the text (for example, 'The paragraph says ...'). It must use details from the paragraph only. Ask: which words in the paragraph tell you that?
20. The friend sentence may be casual (for example: Did you know oryx are back in the desert?) and the newsletter sentence formal and complete (for example: The Arabian oryx has returned to protected desert reserves). Both keep the facts true. Ask: how is your voice different for each reader?